

Aussie Primary Academy

Year 6 Science – Earth and Space Sciences: Natural Disasters & Geological Change

I can: explain how sudden geological events reshape the Earth's surface!

Name: _____

Date: _____

Page 1 – Let's Explore!

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Big Idea

Earth's surface can change suddenly through events like **earthquakes, volcanic eruptions, floods** and **landslides**. These sudden changes are different from the slow changes caused by weathering and erosion.

1 Vocabulary Bank

earthquake

volcano

tectonic plates

landslide

flood

erosion

magma

tsunami

2 Match the event to its cause

Earthquake

→

tectonic plates shifting

Volcanic eruption

→

magma escaping the surface

Tsunami

→

a large undersea earthquake

3 Sudden or Slow change? Circle the correct answer

a) Earthquake Sudden / Slow

b) Erosion by wind Sudden / Slow

c) Volcanic eruption Sudden / Slow

d) Landslide Sudden / Slow

4 True or False

a) Australia has active volcanoes erupting regularly. True / False

b) Earthquakes are caused by moving tectonic plates. True / False

c) A tsunami can be caused by an underwater earthquake. True / False

5 Draw and label how an earthquake or volcano changes the Earth's surface

6 Investigate: Research a real natural disaster

Choose a real earthquake, volcano or flood event. What geological change did it cause?

7 Challenge Question

Why do scientists study natural disasters even though we cannot stop them from happening?

Great Science Thinking!

High-Five Tips for Parents & Teachers

Watch a short, age-appropriate news clip or documentary about a real earthquake or volcano together to make the science feel real.

Discuss how Australia is fairly geologically stable compared to countries on active tectonic plate boundaries like Japan or Indonesia.

Use a globe or map to show where the 'Ring of Fire' is and why so many earthquakes/volcanoes happen there.

Reassure your child if the topic feels scary — frame it as scientists studying and preparing for these events, which helps keep people safe.

Ask 'what warning signs might scientists look for?' to build prediction and observation thinking.

✓ Answer Key

2. Earthquake→tectonic plates shifting, Volcanic eruption→magma escaping, Tsunami→undersea earthquake

3. a) Sudden b) Slow c) Sudden d) Sudden

4. a) False b) True c) True

7. Studying disasters helps scientists predict warning signs and build safer buildings/warning systems to protect people